

Career Prep Checklist — System Features

Parent User Story

As a student,
when I want to do activities that prepare me to get a job when I graduate,
I want a checklist of tasks and events I can do each semester I am in school,
so that I am prepared to successfully apply for a job.

Decisions (from clarification)

Topic	Decision
Users	Students, plus career services / instructors who maintain the official checklist, plus academic advisors who review progress
Completing items	Students check items off themselves. Staff can verify selected official items (for example, resume review or mock interview)
Advisor access	An advisor sees only students assigned to them . Career services / instructors create and change those assignments

System Overview

The system helps students plan and complete career-preparation work across every semester until graduation. It presents official tasks and events (resume work, career fairs, internships, networking, interviews) as a per-semester checklist, lets students add their own items, tracks self-completion, verifies selected high-impact items, and shows how ready the student is to apply for jobs.

Career services / instructors own the official catalog, campus events, resources, verification flags, and advisor–student assignments. Academic advisors coach **their assigned students** using the same progress and readiness views.

Roles

Role	Can do	Cannot do
Student	Maintain academic profile; use semester checklists; check off items; add evidence; add custom items; see own progress, readiness, advisor name, and verification status	Edit the official catalog; verify items; view other students
Career services / instructor	Maintain official tasks, events, timing, and resources; mark items as requiring verification; verify or return any student’s flagged items; assign students to advisors	Use a student’s checklist as if they were that student

Role	Can do	Cannot do
Academic advisor	View roster, checklists, and readiness for assigned students only ; verify or return flagged items for those students; leave notes the student can see	View or advise students not assigned to them; change the official catalog; change advisor assignments

Feature 1: Student Profile and Academic Timeline

Students set up who they are and where they are in school so checklists match their remaining semesters.

User Story 1.1 — Create academic profile

As a student,

I want to enter my major, expected graduation term, and current year/semester,
so that the system can show a plan that fits my remaining time in school.

User Story 1.2 — Update profile when plans change

As a student,

I want to update my graduation term or major,
so that my checklist stays accurate if I change plans.

User Story 1.3 — See remaining semesters

As a student,

I want to see how many semesters I have left,
so that I know how much time I have to complete career-prep activities.

Feature 2: Semester Checklist

The core of the product: a checklist of official and custom tasks and events for each semester.

User Story 2.1 — View checklist for the current semester

As a student,

I want to see a checklist of tasks and events for my current semester,
so that I know what to work on right now.

User Story 2.2 — View checklists for other semesters

As a student,

I want to browse past and future semester checklists,
so that I can plan ahead and review what I have already done.

User Story 2.3 — See recommended activities by academic stage

As a freshman, sophomore, junior, or senior,

I want recommended tasks that match my year (for example, explore careers early, internships mid-program, applications near graduation),
so that I am not overwhelmed with activities that are too early or too late.

User Story 2.4 — Distinguish tasks from events

As a student,

I want tasks (things I complete on my own) and events (career fairs, workshops, info sessions) shown separately or clearly labeled,

so that I can plan both independent work and calendar-based activities.

User Story 2.5 — See official vs custom items

As a student,

I want official catalog items and items I added myself to be easy to tell apart, including which official items require verification,

so that I know what the school expects and what is optional personal tracking.

Feature 3: Task and Event Completion and Verification

Students mark work done. Career services / instructors choose which official items require verification. Those items are confirmed by career services, an instructor, or the student's assigned advisor.

User Story 3.1 — Mark an item complete

As a student,

I want to check off a task or event when I finish it,

so that I can see what I have already accomplished.

User Story 3.2 — Undo a completion I marked

As a student,

I want to uncheck an item I marked complete by mistake, as long as it has not been verified,

so that my checklist stays accurate.

User Story 3.3 — Add notes or evidence to a completed item

As a student,

I want to attach a short note or link (for example, "uploaded resume to Handshake" or a workshop I attended),

so that staff can review what I did and I remember it when I apply for jobs later.

User Story 3.4 — See which items need staff verification

As a student,

I want official items that require verification to be clearly labeled, along with whether they are not submitted, pending, verified, or returned,

so that I know a checkmark alone is not enough for those activities.

User Story 3.5 — Mark selected official items as requiring verification

As a career services staff member or instructor,

I want to mark specific official tasks or events as "requires verification" (for example, resume review or mock

interview),

so that high-impact activities are confirmed, not only self-reported.

User Story 3.6 — Verify any student’s flagged item (career services)

As a career services staff member or instructor,

I want to verify or return (with a short reason) a student-completed item that requires verification,

so that job-readiness reflects confirmed work.

User Story 3.7 — Verify an assigned student’s flagged item (advisor)

As an academic advisor,

I want to verify or return (with a short reason) flagged items for students assigned to me,

so that I can confirm work I reviewed with that student and cannot act on students who are not mine.

User Story 3.8 — Know when an item is verified or returned

As a student,

I want to see on my checklist when staff verifies or returns an item,

so that I can fix it or move on.

Feature 4: Career-Prep Activity Catalog

A library of official tasks and events, maintained by career services / instructors, that the system places on semester checklists.

User Story 4.1 — Browse recommended career-prep activities

As a student,

I want to see a catalog of common activities (resume, LinkedIn, career fair, mock interview, internship search, thank-you notes),

so that I understand the full set of things that help me get a job.

User Story 4.2 — See why an activity matters

As a student,

I want a short description of why each task or event helps my job search,

so that I am motivated to complete it and can explain it on applications or in interviews.

User Story 4.3 — See suggested timing

As a student,

I want each activity to suggest which semester or year it belongs in,

so that I do the right things at the right time.

User Story 4.4 — Maintain the official catalog

As a career services staff member or instructor,

I want to add, edit, archive, and assign official tasks and events to academic stages or semesters,

so that every student sees a current, school-approved plan.

User Story 4.5 — Publish campus events onto checklists

As a career services staff member or instructor,

I want to add dated campus events (career fairs, workshops, employer info sessions) to the relevant semester,
so that students see real opportunities on the same list as their tasks.

User Story 4.6 — Attach resources to official items

As a career services staff member or instructor,

I want to attach links, tips, and campus contacts to each official item,
so that students can complete the work without hunting for information.

Feature 5: Custom Tasks and Events

Students can add their own items, not only official catalog items. Custom items are self-checked only (they do not require staff verification).

User Story 5.1 — Add a custom task to a semester

As a student,

I want to add my own task to a semester checklist,

so that I can track major-specific or personal goals (for example, a department poster session).

User Story 5.2 — Add a custom event

As a student,

I want to add an event with a date (career fair, company visit, club meeting),

so that those opportunities appear on the same checklist as recommended items.

User Story 5.3 — Edit or remove custom items

As a student,

I want to edit or delete items I created,

so that my checklist stays useful and uncluttered.

Feature 6: Progress and Job-Readiness Overview

A summary of how prepared the student is to apply. Items that require verification count as ready only after they are verified.

User Story 6.1 — See semester progress

As a student,

I want to see how many checklist items I have completed this semester, including how many flagged items are still pending verification,

so that I know if I am on track.

User Story 6.2 — See overall progress toward graduation

As a student,

I want to see progress across all semesters,

so that I can tell whether I am building a strong record before I graduate.

User Story 6.3 — See a job-application readiness summary

As a student,

I want a simple readiness view (for example, resume done, internship experience, interview practice, applications started) that treats “requires verification” items as ready only after they are verified,

so that I know whether I am prepared to successfully apply for a job.

Feature 7: Advisor Progress Review

Academic advisors can see **only students assigned to them**. Career services / instructors manage those assignments.

User Story 7.1 — Assign students to an advisor

As a career services staff member or instructor,

I want to assign (and later reassign or unassign) students to an academic advisor,

so that each student has someone who can review their progress.

User Story 7.2 — See a roster of assigned students

As an academic advisor,

I want to see only the students assigned to me and a snapshot of each student’s checklist progress (including pending verifications),

so that I know who may need a conversation this semester and I cannot open other students’ records.

User Story 7.3 — Open an assigned student’s semester checklists

As an academic advisor,

I want to view an assigned student’s current and past semester checklists (official items, self-completion, and verification status),

so that I can advise them on what to do next.

User Story 7.4 — See an assigned student’s job-readiness summary

As an academic advisor,

I want to see the same job-readiness summary the student sees,

so that we can talk about gaps before they apply for jobs.

User Story 7.5 — Leave advising notes on progress

As an academic advisor,

I want to leave a short note on an assigned student’s plan (visible to that student),

so that recommended next steps are recorded after a meeting.

User Story 7.6 — See who my advisor is

As a student,

I want to see the name of the academic advisor assigned to me,
so that I know who can view my progress and who to talk to.

User Story 7.7 — Know who can see my progress

As a student,

I want to know that only my assigned academic advisor, plus career services / instructors who verify items, can view my career-prep checklist and progress,
so that I am not surprised about who can see my work.

Feature 8: Reminders and Upcoming Events

Help students act during the semester, not only at the end.

User Story 8.1 — See upcoming events for this semester

As a student,

I want a list of upcoming career events with dates,
so that I can register and attend them on time.

User Story 8.2 — Get reminded about incomplete priority items

As a student,

I want reminders for incomplete high-priority tasks before the semester ends, including flagged items still pending verification,
so that I do not miss important preparation steps.

Feature 9: Resources Linked to Checklist Items

Official tasks point to help (templates, campus offices, how-tos) supplied in the catalog.

User Story 9.1 — Open resources from a task

As a student,

I want links or tips on a checklist item (resume template, career center hours, Handshake),
so that I can complete the task without hunting for information.

User Story 9.2 — Find campus career services from the app

As a student,

I want to know how to contact career services or related campus offices from relevant tasks,
so that I can get in-person help when I need it.

Feature 10: Account Access and Roles

Users save work across sessions and only see what their role allows.

User Story 10.1 — Create an account and sign in

As a student, career services staff member / instructor, or academic advisor,
I want to create an account (or be given one) and sign in,
so that my work and the correct permissions are saved.

User Story 10.2 — Sign out securely

As a user,
I want to sign out,
so that others using the same device cannot see student progress or staff tools.

User Story 10.3 — Recover access to my account

As a user,
I want to reset my password if I forget it,
so that I can get back to the system.

User Story 10.4 — Use only the tools for my role

As a user,
I want to see only the screens my role is allowed to use (student checklist, catalog admin, or advisor roster),
so that students cannot change the official catalog, advisors cannot see unassigned students, and staff cannot act as the wrong role.

Feature Traceability

Feature	Supports parent goal
Student profile and academic timeline	Checklists match each semester the student is in school
Semester checklist	Tasks and events to do each semester
Completion and verification	Students work the list; selected official items are confirmed by staff
Activity catalog (staff-maintained)	Official, current, job-oriented activities—not a stale or blank list
Custom tasks and events	Student can include their own prep work
Progress and job-readiness	Confidence they are ready to apply; verified items count only when confirmed
Advisor progress review	Assigned advisors coach students; unassigned students stay private
Reminders and upcoming events	Activities happen during the semester, not after it is too late
Resources	Students can actually complete the items
Account access and roles	Progress persists; catalog, verification, and advising stay limited to the right people

Out of Scope (for this story)

The following are not required to fulfill the parent user story:

- Employer or recruiter accounts
- Automatic job applications or resume submission to employers
- Guaranteed job placement
- Degree planning, course registration, or full academic advising outside career-prep progress
- Advisors browsing or searching the entire student body
- Social networking between students (beyond optional event attendance)
- Career services or advisors applying to jobs on a student's behalf